

Stop reading the wrong books!

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 17, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/FZ884Y4BD0g> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter runs through five commonly read self-help books and swaps each for a better alternative, prioritizing actionability, specificity, and proven frameworks over vague inspiration.

Contents

-  Swap 1: Make Your Bed → Extreme Ownership
-  Swap 2: The 5 AM Club → The One Thing
-  Swap 3: The Power of Positive Thinking → Awaken the Giant Within
-  Swap 4: The Power of Now → Stress Less, Accomplish More
-  Swap 5: How to Talk to Anyone → How to Win Friends and Influence People

Swap 1: Make Your Bed → Extreme Ownership 0:00

- **Original book:** *Make Your Bed*
 - Described as "fine" — not bad, but not the best option on the topic
- **Recommended swap:** *Extreme Ownership*
 - Same core topic: discipline and personal responsibility
 - Goes deeper — shows you *how* to be disciplined and take full responsibility for your own life
 - Framed as a strictly better book on the same subject matter

Swap 2: The 5 AM Club → The One Thing 0:05

- **Original book:** *The 5 AM Club*
 - Also described as "fine"
- **Recommended swap:** *The One Thing*
 - Key argument: the specific time you wake up is irrelevant — what matters is actually doing what you need to do to accomplish your goals
 - *The One Thing* teaches you how to identify and execute on that singular priority
 - More results-focused rather than routine-focused

Swap 3: The Power of Positive Thinking → Awaken the Giant Within 0:14

- **Original book:** *The Power of Positive Thinking*
 - Acknowledged as a "great book"
- **Recommended swap:** *Awaken the Giant Within*
 - Also acknowledged as a "great book" — this is the closest to an equal swap in the list
 - Key differentiator: *Awaken the Giant Within* contains **more actionable insights** you can implement immediately
 - The edge goes to actionability over inspiration alone

Swap 4: The Power of Now → Stress Less, Accomplish More 0:23

- **Original book:** *The Power of Now* by Eckhart Tolle
 - Described as "fine" but criticized for being "not actionable" — "very esoteric and vague"
- **Recommended swap:** *Stress Less, Accomplish More*
 - Subject: meditation — directly addresses getting your mind right
 - Two-part value the author provides:
 - Presents the scientific studies that *prove why* you should meditate
 - Gives a step-by-step roadmap for *how* to do it exactly
 - Combines evidence-based justification with a clear practical method — the combination *The Power of Now* lacks

The clearest articulation of his overall philosophy: a good book doesn't just tell you *what* or *why* — it tells you *how*, with steps you can follow today.

Swap 5: How to Talk to Anyone → How to Win Friends and Influence People 0:45

- **Original book:** *How to Talk to Anyone*
- **Recommended swap:** *How to Win Friends and Influence People* by Dale Carnegie
 - Described as **"by far the best book"** on human relations and dealing with others
 - No qualifier of "fine" here — the strongest endorsement of any swap in the video
 - Positioned as the definitive text on the topic, making the alternative essentially redundant